

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

When I was a young student in business school, Harry Lang, a professor, told me there was no substitute for experience. At the time, that meant nothing to me. Then came the real world, which hit me like a ton of bricks. Now I know he spoke with the wisdom granted only by the passage of time.

In my life, I have experienced great successes and catastrophic failures. I have lost millions and made them back. I have started many businesses, some of which died on the vine and others that I sold for billions of dollars.

It would have been impossible for me to write this book without the cumulative experiences of my journey. Along the way, I have learned lessons from the most vicious competitors, business partners, loyal friends, employees, brilliant investors, crafty politicians, and inspiring artists. Some of these men and women are close friends today; others I have not spoken to in years. Still, I have never forgotten the lessons these people have taught me. I would like to list all of their names here but practicality stops me, so instead, I acknowledge them knowing with certainty they know who they are. In a way, they wrote this book for me and I was just the scribe who inked the paper. I give them my thanks now.

I also want to give accolades to my literary collaborators, Lisa Gabriele and Bree Barton. The written word is permanent, and working with great artists like these makes it worth doing.

Finally, I wish to thank my parents, George and Georgette, who were my constant allies and advisors throughout my life. If it is the burden of parents to pass their knowledge to their children, then they can rest assured that their job is done and mine has just begun.

I wrote this book for anyone who wants to tap my database of experiences. I hope that this book helps those on their own journeys;